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Image capture device and operation method thereof

Abstract

An operation method of an image capture device includes steps as follows. The MEMS driver is controlled through the field programmable gate array (FPGA) independently to adjust at least one micro electro mechanical system (MEMS) scanning mirror of the optical system; at least one digital signal provided by the linear image sensor module is processed through the FPGA directly so as to obtain at least one image data.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority to Taiwan Patent Application No. 112126981, filed Jul. 19, 2023, the entirety of which is herein incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

Field of Invention

(2) The present invention relates to capture devices and more particularly, an image capture device and an operating method thereof.

Description of Related Art

(3) Currently, most optical systems of medical imaging are equipped with light sources, scanning mirrors and circuit systems in terms of image receiving and processing equipment, resulting in the overall cost of the optical system being quite high, which greatly limits the acceptance of general clinics or home health care. The optical systems are generally only available in large eye centers or hospitals, and the universality of the optical systems is not high. Most optical systems currently on the market are relatively large in size and require additional large-scale computers for data processing, which also limits the convenience of optical systems.

(4) Although there are currently a few handheld or home-type portable scanners available, the image receiving end of such portable scanners still uses large computer devices for calculations. The installation of large computers also means that their convenience is relatively poor, and the system cost is too high.

SUMMARY

(5) In one or more various aspects, the present disclosure is directed to an image capture device and an operating method thereof.

(6) One embodiment of the present disclosure is related to an image capture device, which includes a linear image sensor module, a MEMS (micro electro mechanical system) driver and a FPGA (field programmable gate array). The linear image sensor module is aligned with a lens of an optical system, and the lens located between a grating of the optical system and the linear image sensor module. The MEMS driver is electrically connected to at least one MEMS scanning mirror of the optical system. The FPGA is electrically connected to the linear image sensor module and the MEMS driver, where the FPGA independently controls the MEMS driver to adjust the at least one MEMS scanning mirror, and the FPGA directly processes at least one digital signal provided by the linear image sensor module, so as to obtain at least one image data.

(7) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the FPGA simultaneously processes a plurality of threads of execution of the linear image sensor module and simultaneously processes a plurality of threads of execution of the MEMS driver.

(8) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the linear image sensor module includes a plurality of analog-to-digital converters, a plurality of CCD (charge-coupled device) sensors and a plurality of driving circuits. The analog-to-digital converters are electrically connected to the FPGA. The CCD sensors are electrically connected to the analog-to-digital converters. The driving circuits are electrically connected to the CCD sensors respectively, and the driving circuits are electrically connected to the FPGA, where the FPGA drives the CCD sensors through the driving circuits simultaneously, so that the CCD sensors output a plurality of pixel analog signals to the analog-to-digital converters respectively, the analog-to-digital converters convert the pixel analog signals into a plurality of digital signals respectively, and the FPGA processes the digital signals simultaneously, so as to obtain the at least one image data.

(9) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the at least one MEMS scanning mirror includes a plurality of MEMS scanning mirrors, and the MEMS driver includes a plurality of amplifiers and a plurality of digital-to-analog converters. The amplifiers are electrically connected to the plurality of the MEMS scanning mirrors. The digital-to-analog converters are electrically connected to the plurality of the amplifiers, and the digital-to-analog converters are electrically connected to the FPGA, where the FPGA simultaneously sends a plurality of trigger signals to the digital-to-analog converters, so that the digital-to-analog converters send a plurality of analog triangle wave signals to the amplifiers respectively, and the amplifiers send a plurality of amplified analog triangle wave signals to the MEMS scanning mirrors respectively.

(10) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the FPGA uses its block RAM (block random access memory) to synthesize a read-only memory, the read-only memory accesses a triangular

wave digital value and a register value corresponding to a functional configuration of each of the digital-to-analog converters, the FPGA transmits the triangular wave digital value and the register value to a SRAM (static random-access memory) of each of the digital-to-analog converters through a serial peripheral interface, after the functional configuration of each of the digital-to-analog converters is completed, the FPGA simultaneously gives the trigger signals to the digital-to-analog converters, each of the digital-to-analog converters correspondingly converts the triangular wave digital value in the SRAM into the analog triangle wave signal and outputs the analog triangle wave signal to a corresponding one of the amplifiers, and the amplified analog triangle wave signal output by each of the amplifiers matches a driving voltage range of each corresponding one of the MEMS scanning mirrors.

(11) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the image capture device further includes a USB (universal serial bus) control chip and a USB port. The USB control chip is electrically connected to the FPGA. The USB port is electrically connected to the USB control chip, where the USB port is configured to connect a display device, and the FPGA causes the display device to render an imaging screen based on the at least one image data through the USB control chip.

(12) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, an objective lens of the optical system is disposed between an interferometer and an ultrasonic transducer, and when the objective lens is aligned with a biological tissue, the ultrasonic transducer is located between the objective lens and the biological tissue.

(13) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the optical system includes the objective lens and the interferometer, an ultrasound system includes the ultrasonic transducer, and the FPGA simultaneously supports a synchronous operation of the optical system and the ultrasound system.

(14) Another embodiment of the present disclosure is related to an operation method of an image capture device. The operation method includes steps of: (A) individually controlling a MEMS driver through a FPGA to adjust at least one MEMS scanning mirror of an optical system; (B) directly processing at least one digital signal provided by a linear image sensor module through the FPGA, so as to obtain at least one image data.

(15) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the operation method further includes: simultaneously processing a plurality of threads of execution of the MEMS driver through the FPGA.

(16) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the operation method further includes: simultaneously processing a plurality of threads of execution of the linear image sensor module through the FPGA.

(17) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the linear image sensor module includes a plurality of analog-to-digital converters, a plurality of CCD sensors and a plurality of driving circuits, and the step (B) includes: using the FPGA to drive the CCD sensors through the driving circuits simultaneously, so that the CCD sensors output a plurality of pixel analog signals to the analog-to-digital converters respectively; using the analog-to-digital converters to convert the pixel analog signals into a plurality of digital signals respectively; and using the FPGA to process the digital signals simultaneously, so as to obtain the at least one image data.

(18) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the at least one MEMS scanning mirror includes a plurality of MEMS scanning mirrors, the MEMS driver includes a plurality of amplifiers and a plurality of digital-to-analog converters, and the step (A) includes: using the FPGA simultaneously to send a plurality of trigger signals to the digital-to-analog converters, so that the digital-to-analog converters send a plurality of analog triangle wave signals to the amplifiers respectively; and using the amplifiers to send a plurality of amplified analog triangle wave signals to the MEMS scanning mirrors respectively.

(19) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the step (A) further includes: using a block RAM of the FPGA to synthesize a read-only memory, where the read-only memory accesses a triangular wave digital value and a register value corresponding to a functional configuration of each of the

digital-to-analog converters; using the FPGA to transmit the triangular wave digital value and the register value to a SRAM of each of the digital-to analog converters through a serial peripheral interface; after the functional configuration of each of the digital-to-analog converters is completed, using the FPGA simultaneously to give the trigger signals to the digital-to-analog converters, so that each of the digital-to-analog converters correspondingly converts the triangular wave digital value in the SRAM into the analog triangle wave signal and outputs the analog triangle wave signal to a corresponding one of the amplifiers, where the amplified analog triangle wave signal output by each of the amplifiers matches a driving voltage range of each corresponding one of the MEMS scanning mirrors.

(20) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the operation method further includes: using the FPGA causes a display device to render an imaging screen based on the at least one image data through a USB control chip.

(21) Technical advantages are generally achieved, by embodiments of the present disclosure. Through the image capture device and its operation method of the present disclosure, the portable optical scanner (e.g., the optical system) and the ultrasound system (e.g., the ultrasonic transducer, etc.) can use FPGA to implement scanning mechanisms and image processing at the same time, thereby reducing the overall volume. Furthermore, the FPGA can process multiple threads of execution at the same time, thereby greatly saving computing time.

(22) Many of the attendant features will be more readily appreciated, as the same becomes better understood by reference to the following detailed description considered in connection with the accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The invention can be more fully understood by reading the following detailed description of the embodiment, with reference made to the accompanying drawings as follows:

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an image capture device according to one embodiment of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a linear image sensor module according to one embodiment of the present disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a MEMS driver according to one embodiment of the present disclosure;

(5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an image capture device according to another embodiment of the present disclosure;

(6) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of an optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device according to one embodiment of the present disclosure;

(7) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of an optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device according to one embodiment of the present disclosure;

(8) FIG. 7 shows intensity distribution results under different wave irradiation modes according to one embodiment of the present disclosure;

(9) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of an image capture device according to yet another embodiment of the present disclosure; and

(10) FIG. 9 is a flow chart of an operation method of an image capture device according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) Reference will now be made in detail to the present embodiments of the invention, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers are used in the drawings and the description to refer to the same or like parts.

(12) Referring to FIG. 1, in one aspect, the present disclosure is directed to an image capture device **100**. This image capture device may be easily integrated into a portable medical imaging device and may be applicable or readily adaptable to all technologies. Accordingly, the image capture device **100** has advantages. Herewith the image capture device **100** is described below with FIG. 1.

(13) The subject disclosure provides the image capture device **100** in accordance with the subject technology. Various aspects of the present technology are described with reference to the drawings. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of one or more aspects. It can be evident, however, that the present technology can be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to facilitate describing these aspects. The word “exemplary” is used herein to mean “serving as an example, instance, or illustration.” Any embodiment described herein as “exemplary” is not necessarily to be construed as preferred or advantageous over other embodiments.

(14) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a image capture device **100** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 1, the image capture device **100** includes a linear image sensor module **101**, a MEMS driver **102**, a FPGA **103**, an USB control chip **104**, an USB port **105**, a DDR RAM (Double Data Rate Random-Access Memory) **106** and a crystal oscillator **107**.

(15) In structure, the FPGA **103** is electrically connected to the linear image sensor module **101** and the MEMS driver **102**. The MEMS driver **102** is electrically connected to the MEMS scanning mirror **192** of the optical system **190**. The linear image sensor module **101** is aligned with a lens and a grating **191** (e.g., a focusing lens and a grating) of the optical system **190**. The USB control chip **104** is electrically connected to the FPGA **103**, and the USB port **105** is electrically connected to the USB control chip **104**. The DDR RAM **106** and crystal oscillator **107** are electrically connected to the FPGA **103**.

(16) In use, the FPGA **103** independently controls the MEMS driver **102** to adjust the MEMS scanning mirror **192**, and the FPGA **103** directly processes at least one digital signal provided by the linear image sensor module **101**, so as to obtain at least one image data. In this way, the image capture device **100** does not need to be equipped with a computer, and can realize the scanning mechanism and image processing through the FPGA **103**, thereby reducing the overall size.

(17) Specifically, the optical system **190** (e.g., a spectrometer) is calibrated to be fixed to the linear image sensor module **101**, and the connection uses the circuit board of the FPGA **103** with a flexible bus. The crystal oscillator **107** provides a clock signal, and the FPGA **103** controls the MEMS driver **102** to rotate the MEMS scanning mirror **192** to reflect light to different positions of the sample; at the same time, the FPGA **103** drives the linear image sensor module **101** to receive the spectral interference signal of each position of the sample, and the FPGA **103** receives the original image data. Whenever the MEMS driver **102** rotates for one unit time, the linear image sensor module **101** can scan the output signal of the optical system **190** and send the output signal to the FPGA **103** to obtain a one-dimensional image. After the MEMS scanning mirror **192** completes one cycle, the FPGA **103** can receive the complete two-dimensional image of the sample, and this image is stored in DDR RAM **106** as a frame buffer. At this time, the FPGA **103** can use the image data for optical coherent tomography (OCT) image processing. The processed image data can be transmitted to the display device through the USB control chip **104** and the USB port **105**.

(18) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the FPGA **103** simultaneously processes a plurality of threads of execution of the linear image sensor module **101** and simultaneously processes a plurality of threads of execution of the MEMS driver **102**, thereby greatly saving computing time. In a controlled experiment, the FPGA **103** is replaced by a computer for calculation, or the FPGA **103** is simply used as a data transmission medium and the computer is used for calculation. Since the computer only can process serial information one by one, it cannot process multiple threads of execution at the same time, resulting in low performance.

(19) For a more complete understanding of the hardware architecture of the linear image sensor module **101**, refer to FIG. 1 and FIG. 2. FIG. 2 is a block diagram of the linear image sensor module **101** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 2, the linear image sensor module **101** includes a plurality of analog-to-digital converters **201**, a plurality of CCD sensors **202** and a plurality of driving circuits **203**. For example, the CCD sensor **202** is a linear array CCD sensor.

(20) In structure, the analog-to-digital converters **201** are electrically connected to the FPGA **103**, the CCD sensors **202** are electrically connected to the analog-to-digital converters **201**, and the driving circuits **203** are electrically connected to the CCD sensors **202**. The driving circuits **203** are electrically connected to the FPGA **103**.

(21) In use, the FPGA **103** drives the CCD sensors **202** through the driving circuits **203** simultaneously, so that the CCD sensors **202** output a plurality of pixel analog signals to the analog-to-digital converters **201** respectively, the analog-to-digital converters **201** convert the pixel analog signals into a plurality of digital signals respectively, and the FPGA **103** processes the digital signals simultaneously so as to obtain the at least one image data and can simultaneously trigger the synchronous action function of another imaging devices (e.g., the ultrasound system in FIG. 4). In this way, the FPGA **103** simultaneously processes multiple threads of execution of multiple analog-to-digital converters **201** in the linear image sensor module **101**, thereby greatly saving the computing time.

(22) Specifically, in one embodiment of the present disclosure, the FPGA **103** uses its block RAM to synthesize a read-only memory (ROM) **210** to access the data value of one function configuration of each of the analog-to-digital converters **201**, and uses serial transmission to perform the initial configuration on the analog-to-digital converters **201** for setting the register value of each function in the analog-to-digital converters **201**. After the function configuration of each of the analog-to-digital converters **201** is completed, the FPGA **103** can output the driving clocks of the CCD sensors **202** respectively. The driving clocks through the driving circuits **203** to convert the voltage levels of the driving clocks into the voltage levels required by the CCD sensors **202**. After the driving of multiple CCD sensors **202** is completed, corresponding pixel analog signals can be output to the analog-to-digital converters **201** respectively. Cache amplifiers can be designed between the CCD sensors **202** and the analog-to-digital converters **201**, so that the output signals of the CCD sensors **202** have enough driving capability to drive multiple analog front-end circuits in the analog-to-digital converters **201**. The analog-to-digital converters **201** can convert the output signals from the CCD sensors **202** into digital signals. The digital signals can be transmitted to the FPGA **103** through the flexible bus, so that the FPGA **103** can obtain the original image data.

(23) For a more complete understanding of the hardware architecture of the MEMS driver **102**, refer to FIG. 1 and FIG. 3. FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a MEMS driver **102** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 3, the MEMS driver **102** includes amplifiers **301** and digital-to-analog converters **302**. The number of the MEMS scanning mirrors **192** is correspondingly multiple.

(24) In structure, the amplifiers **301** are electrically connected to the MEMS scanning mirrors **192**, the digital-to-analog converters **302** are electrically connected to the amplifiers **301**, and the digital-to-analog converters **302** are electrically connected to the FPGA **103**.

(25) In use, the FPGA **103** sends trigger signals to the digital-to-analog converters **302** at the same time, so that the digital-to-analog converters **302** can send analog triangle wave signals to the amplifiers **301** respectively, and the amplifiers **301** can send the amplified analog triangle wave signals to the MEMS scanning mirrors **192** respectively. In this way, the FPGA **103** simultaneously processes multiple threads of execution of the digital-to-analog converters **302** in the MEMS driver **102**, thereby greatly saving computing time.

(26) The MEMS scanning mirror **192** is used to rotate in a voltage-driven manner, that is, within a

certain voltage range, the angle of the MEMS scanning mirror **192** can rotate to different positions according to different voltage values. Therefore, the present disclosure uses triangular waves as the rotation control signal of the MEMS scanning mirror **192** and periodically provides a triangular wave to the MEMS scanning mirror **192**, so that the MEMS scanning mirror **192** can rotate back and forth regularly.

(27) Specifically, in some embodiments of the present disclosure, the FPGA **103** uses its block RAM (block random access memory) to synthesize a read-only memory **210**, the read-only memory **210** accesses a triangular wave digital value and a register value corresponding to a functional configuration of each of the digital-to-analog converters **302**, the FPGA **103** transmits the triangular wave digital value and the register value to a SRAM (static random-access memory) **310** of each of the digital-to-analog converters through a serial peripheral interface **320**. After the functional configuration of each of the digital-to-analog converters **302** is completed, the FPGA **103** simultaneously gives the trigger signals to the digital-to-analog converters **302**, each of the digital-to-analog converters **302** correspondingly converts the triangular wave digital value in the SRAM **310** into the analog triangle wave signal and outputs the analog triangle wave signal to a corresponding one of the amplifiers **301**, and the amplified analog triangle wave signal output by each of the amplifiers **301** matches a driving voltage range of each corresponding one of the MEMS scanning mirrors **192**.

(28) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the USB port **105** is configured to connect a display device, and the FPGA **103** causes the display device to render an imaging screen based on the at least one image data through the USB control chip **104**. At the same time, through the synchronous triggering function of the USB control chip **104**, the operation of other devices can be triggered synchronously, such as the synchronous action function of the ultrasonic system (e.g., an ultrasonic actuator, an ultrasonic imaging device, etc.) in FIG. 4. In practice, for example, the USB control chip **104** and the USB port **105** support USB 3.0 to transmit large amounts of data in real time, allowing the FPGA **103** to implement a state machine to complete data streaming transmission.

(29) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an image capture device **400** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 4, the image capture device **400** includes a detection end **403**, a computing device **404**, a power amplifier **405** and a power meter **406**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the computing device **404** is the FPGA **103** in FIG. 1, and the detection end **403** is a pin of the FPGA **103**.

(30) In structure, the detection end **403** is electrically connected to the computing device **404**, the computing device **404** is electrically connected to the power amplifier **405**, and the power amplifier **405** is electrically connected to the power meter **406**.

(31) On the other hand, in some embodiments of the present disclosure, the optical system **190** in FIG. 1 can include an OCT light source **401**, an interferometer **402**, and an optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device **410**. The optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device **410** includes an objective lens **411** and an ultrasonic transducer **412**. For example, the ultrasonic transducer **412** can be a dual-purpose focused ultrasonic transducer that is both transceiver and transceiver.

(32) In structure, the OCT light source **401** is connected to the interferometer **402**, the interferometer **402** is electrically connected to the detection end **403**, and the power meter **406** is electrically connected to the ultrasonic transducer **412**. In this way, the optical system (e.g., the OCT light source **401**, the interferometer **402** and the objective lens **411**) and the ultrasonic system (e.g., the ultrasonic transducer **412**, the power amplifier **405** and the power meter **406**) can use the computing device **404** (e.g., the FPGA **103** in FIG. 1, the USB control chip **104**, etc.) implements scanning mechanism and image processing. For example, through the synchronous triggering function of the USB control chip **104**, the synchronous action of the ultrasonic actuator can be triggered synchronously. In other words, the computing device **404** (e.g., the FPGA **103** in FIG. 1, the USB control chip **104**, etc.) can simultaneously support the

synchronous operation of the above-mentioned optical system and the above-mentioned ultrasound system.

(33) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, in order to allow the beam of the OCT light source **401** and the focused ultrasound (FUS) signal of the ultrasonic transducer **412** to illuminate the same area and the same depth, the ultrasonic transducer **412** is set up at the scanning end of the optical system. The optical coherent tomography beam is focused by the objective lens **411** and then hits the biological tissue **490**. The ultrasonic focus depth of the ultrasonic transducer **412** can be designed to be the same as the depth of the optical coherent tomography beam. Therefore, the optical coherent tomography beam and the focused ultrasound signal are focused on the same range and depth to achieve simultaneous monitoring and treatment.

(34) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the objective lens **411** is disposed between the interferometer **402** and the ultrasonic transducer **412**. When the objective lens **411** is aligned with the biological tissue **490**, the ultrasonic transducer **412** is located between the objective lens **411** and the biological tissue **490**. In other words, the objective lens **411** and ultrasonic transducer **412** of the optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device **410** both face the same side of the biological tissue **490**, so that the optical coherent tomography beam and the focused ultrasonic signal are focused on the same range and depth. In a control experiment, the objective lens and ultrasonic transducer are placed on opposite sides of the biological tissue. When the biological tissue is the human eye, the objective lens and ultrasonic transducer of the control experiment need to be located on both sides of the head, thereby causing the system to be too large, and the ultrasound passes through the head to cause too much noise. If the ultrasound power is increased, it will cause brain damage.

(35) For a more complete understanding of the hardware architecture of the optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device **410**, refer to FIG. 4, FIG. 5 and FIG. 6. FIG. 5 is a perspective view of an optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device **410** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of an optical scanning and ultrasonic combined device **410** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIGS. 5 and 6, the present disclosure miniaturizes and integrates the scanning end of the optical coherent tomography the ultrasonic transducer **412**. The ultrasonic transducer **412** is arranged on the periphery of the objective lens **411**, thereby leaving a hole in the center for the light path of the optical coherent tomography area to pass through. In addition, the ultrasonic waves need to be transmitted through the medium to avoid loss, so a container **510** is set outside objective lens **411**, and container **510** is filled with water to facilitate the propagation of ultrasonic waves. In addition, the water container with its specifications can also be set up in the reference arm of optical coherent tomography to eliminate system dispersion.

(36) In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the present disclosure selects microbubbles as a developer to enhance the image contrast of optical coherent tomography. In order to verify the enhancement effect of microbubbles on optical coherent tomography scattering signals, the microbubbles are first dissolved in an aqueous solution for dilution, then pour the aqueous solution containing microbubbles into a drip tube, and then use the rear-end drip pump to promote the flow of liquid in the tube. The drip tube is fixed under the optical system, and the optical system scans the drip tube; at the same time, the ultrasonic transducer **412** emits ultrasound waves of different powers to the drip tube, the ultrasound application mode is set to a pulsed wave mode and a continuous wave mode, and the ultrasound power is set to 0.9, 4.9 and 9.9 W respectively. When the ultrasound power continues to increase, the image of the drip tube also continues to become stronger. Especially when the ultrasound irradiation mode is continuous wave mode, the image is significantly enhanced. Even when only low-power continuous wave irradiation is used, the image of the drip tube can also be enhanced.

(37) FIG. 7 shows intensity distribution results under different wave irradiation modes according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. In order to quantitatively compare the difference in

intensity improvement, the present disclosure compares the scanning signals under three different conditions, namely, no ultrasonic irradiation (a), irradiation of 9.9 W of the ultrasonic pulse wave form (b), and irradiation of 9.9 W of the continuous wave form (c), the result is shown in FIG. 7. The intensity of figure (c) is enhanced to 14 dB as compared with figure (a), and it can also enhance the optical coherent tomography scattering signal at a deeper depth, thus proving that the microbubbles with the ultrasound irradiation can significantly improve the contrast of optical coherent tomography images. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the microbubbles are supplemented with low-power ultrasound irradiation as an intravascular scattering enhancement source to greatly improve the contrast of vascular imaging, thereby confirming the location of disease signs, and then applying high-power focused ultrasound to help increase the local vascular permeability so as to promote the drug release efficiency to improve the treatment effectiveness.

(38) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of an image capture device **100** according to yet another embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 8, the FPGA **103** is electrically connected to the USB device **810**, and the USB device **810** is configured to electrically connect a display device **812**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the USB device **810** can include the USB control chip **104** and the USB port **105** in FIG. 1.

(39) In the optical system **190**, the beam of the broadband light source **830** enters the optical collimator **843** to the optocoupler **840**, and the optical path of the optical collimator **844** is aligned with the lens **860** to the reflective mirror **862**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the broadband light source **830** can be the OCT light source **401** in FIG. 4.

(40) As to the sample **870**, in some embodiments of the present disclosure, the eye of the sample **870** can be the biological tissue **490** in FIG. 4. The optical path goes from the sample **870** through the lens **850**, the MEMS scanning mirror **192** to the optical collimator **841**.

(41) On the other hand, the linear image sensor module **101** is aligned with the lens **820** (e.g., an achromatic lens) of the optical system **190**; the lens **820** is located between the grating **822** of the optical system **190** and the linear image sensor module **101**. In some embodiments of the present disclosure, the lens and the grating **191** in FIG. 1 can include a lens **820** (e.g., a focus lens) and a grating **822**. The light beam output by optical collimator **842** is modulated by the grating **822** and reflected to the lens **820**, and the light beam is sensed by linear image sensor module **101**.

(42) For a more complete understanding of an operation method of the image capture device **100**, referring FIGS. 1-9, FIG. 9 is a flow chart of the operation method **900** of the image capture device **100** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 9, the operation method **900** includes steps **S901** and **S902**. However, as could be appreciated by persons having ordinary skill in the art, for the steps described in the present embodiment, the sequence in which these steps is performed, unless explicitly stated otherwise, can be altered depending on actual needs; in certain cases, all or some of these steps can be performed concurrently.

(43) The operation method **900** may take the form of a computer program product on a computer-readable storage medium having computer-readable instructions embodied in the medium. Any suitable storage medium may be used including non-volatile memory such as read only memory (ROM), programmable read only memory (PROM), erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM), and electrically erasable programmable read only memory (EEPROM) devices; volatile memory such as SRAM, DRAM, and DDR-RAM; optical storage devices such as CD-ROMs and DVD-ROMs; and magnetic storage devices such as hard disk drives and floppy disk drives.

(44) In step **S901**, the FPGA **103** individually controls the MEMS driver **102** to adjust at least one MEMS scanning mirror **192** of the optical system **190**. In step **S902**, the FPGA **103** directly processes at least one digital signal provided by a linear image sensor module **101**, so as to obtain at least one image data. In this way, operation method **900** does not need to be equipped with a computer, and can realize the scanning mechanism and image processing through FPGA **103**, reducing the overall size.

(45) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the operation method **900** further includes:

simultaneously processing a plurality of threads of execution of the MEMS driver **102** through the FPGA **103**, thereby greatly saving the processing time for driving. For example, through the synchronous triggering function of the USB control chip **104**, the operation of other devices can be triggered synchronously, such as the synchronous action function of the above-mentioned ultrasonic system (e.g., an ultrasonic actuator, an ultrasonic imaging device, etc.).

(46) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the operation method **900** further includes: simultaneously processing a plurality of threads of execution of the linear image sensor module **101** through the FPGA **103**, thereby greatly saving image processing time.

(47) In view of the above, technical advantages are generally achieved, by embodiments of the present disclosure. Through the image capture device **100** and its operation method **900** of the present disclosure, the portable optical scanner (e.g., the optical system) and the ultrasound system (e.g., the ultrasonic transducer, etc.) can use FPGA **103** to implement scanning mechanisms and image processing at the same time, thereby reducing the overall volume. Furthermore, the FPGA **103** can process multiple threads of execution at the same time, thereby greatly saving computing time.

(48) It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the structure of the present invention without departing from the scope or spirit of the invention. In view of the foregoing, it is intended that the present invention cover modifications and variations of this invention provided they fall within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. An image capture device, comprising: a linear image sensor module aligned with a lens of an optical system, and the lens located between a grating of the optical system and the linear image sensor module; a MEMS (micro electro mechanical system) driver electrically connected to at least one MEMS scanning mirror of the optical system; and a FPGA (field programmable gate array) electrically connected to the linear image sensor module and the MEMS driver, wherein the FPGA independently controls the MEMS driver to adjust the at least one MEMS scanning mirror, and the FPGA directly processes at least one digital signal provided by the linear image sensor module, so as to obtain at least one image data, wherein the FPGA uses its block RAM (block random access memory) to synthesize a read-only memory, the read-only memory accesses a triangular wave digital value and a register value corresponding to a functional configuration of each of a plurality of digital-to-analog converters, the FPGA transmits the triangular wave digital value and the register value to a SRAM (static random-access memory) of each of the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters through a serial peripheral interface, after the functional configuration of each of the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters is completed, the FPGA simultaneously gives a plurality of trigger signals to the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters, each of the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters correspondingly converts the triangular wave digital value in the SRAM into an analog triangle wave signal and outputs the analog triangle wave signal to a corresponding one of a plurality of amplifiers, and an amplified analog triangle wave signal output by each of the plurality of the amplifiers matches a driving voltage range of each corresponding one of the plurality of the MEMS scanning mirrors.

2. The image capture device of claim 1, wherein the FPGA simultaneously processes a plurality of threads of execution of the linear image sensor module and simultaneously processes a plurality of threads of execution of the MEMS driver.

3. The image capture device of claim 1, wherein the linear image sensor module comprises: a plurality of analog-to-digital converters electrically connected to the FPGA; a plurality of CCD (charge-coupled device) sensors electrically connected to the plurality of the analog-to-digital converters; and a plurality of driving circuits electrically connected to the plurality of the CCD sensors respectively, and the plurality of the driving circuits electrically connected to the FPGA,

wherein the FPGA drives the plurality of the CCD sensors through the driving circuits simultaneously, so that the plurality of the CCD sensors output a plurality of pixel analog signals to the plurality of the analog-to-digital converters respectively, the plurality of the analog-to-digital converters convert the plurality of the pixel analog signals into a plurality of digital signals respectively, and the FPGA processes the plurality of the digital signals simultaneously, so as to obtain the at least one image data.

4. The image capture device of claim 1, wherein the at least one MEMS scanning mirror comprises a plurality of MEMS scanning mirrors, and the MEMS driver comprises: the plurality of the amplifiers electrically connected to the plurality of the MEMS scanning mirrors; and the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters electrically connected to the plurality of the amplifiers, and the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters electrically connected to the FPGA, wherein the FPGA simultaneously sends the plurality of the trigger signals to the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters, so that the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters send the analog triangle wave signals to the plurality of the amplifiers respectively, and the plurality of the amplifiers send the amplified analog triangle wave signals to the plurality of the MEMS scanning mirrors respectively.

5. The image capture device of claim 1, further comprising: a USB (universal serial bus) control chip electrically connected to the FPGA; and a USB port electrically connected to the USB control chip, wherein the USB port is configured to connect a display device, and the FPGA causes the display device to render an imaging screen based on the at least one image data through the USB control chip.

6. The image capture device of claim 1, wherein an objective lens of the optical system is disposed between an interferometer and an ultrasonic transducer, and when the objective lens is aligned with a biological tissue, the ultrasonic transducer is located between the objective lens and the biological tissue.

7. The image capture device of claim 6, wherein the optical system comprises the objective lens and the interferometer, an ultrasound system comprises the ultrasonic transducer, and the FPGA simultaneously supports a synchronous operation of the optical system and the ultrasound system.

8. An operation method of an image capture device, and the operation method comprising steps of: (A) individually controlling a MEMS (micro electro mechanical system) driver through a FPGA (field programmable gate array) to adjust at least one MEMS scanning mirror of an optical system; and (B) directly processing at least one digital signal provided by a linear image sensor module through the FPGA, so as to obtain at least one image data, wherein the step (A) further comprises: using a block RAM (block random access memory) of the FPGA to synthesize a read-only memory, wherein the read-only memory accesses a triangular wave digital value and a register value corresponding to a functional configuration of each of a plurality of digital-to-analog converters; using the FPGA to transmit the triangular wave digital value and the register value to a SRAM (static random-access memory) of each of the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters through a serial peripheral interface; after the functional configuration of each of the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters is completed, using the FPGA simultaneously to give a plurality of trigger signals to the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters, so that each of the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters correspondingly converts the triangular wave digital value in the SRAM into an analog triangle wave signal and outputs the analog triangle wave signal to a corresponding one of a plurality of amplifiers, wherein an amplified analog triangle wave signal output by each of the plurality of the amplifiers matches a driving voltage range of each corresponding one of the plurality of the MEMS scanning mirrors.

9. The operation method of claim 8, further comprising: simultaneously processing a plurality of threads of execution of the MEMS driver through the FPGA.

10. The operation method of claim 8, further comprising: simultaneously processing a plurality of threads of execution of the linear image sensor module through the FPGA.

11. The operation method of claim 8, wherein the linear image sensor module comprises a plurality

of analog-to-digital converters, a plurality of CCD (charge-coupled device) sensors and a plurality of driving circuits, and the step (B) comprises: using the FPGA to drive the plurality of the CCD sensors through the driving circuits simultaneously, so that the plurality of the CCD sensors output a plurality of pixel analog signals to the plurality of the analog-to-digital converters respectively; using the plurality of the analog-to-digital converters to convert the plurality of the pixel analog signals into a plurality of digital signals respectively; and using the FPGA to process the plurality of the digital signals simultaneously, so as to obtain the at least one image data.

12. The operation method of claim 8, wherein the at least one MEMS scanning mirror comprises a plurality of MEMS scanning mirrors, the MEMS driver comprises the plurality of the amplifiers and the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters, and the step (A) comprises: using the FPGA simultaneously to send the plurality of the trigger signals to the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters, so that the plurality of the digital-to-analog converters send the analog triangle wave signals to the plurality of the amplifiers respectively; and using the plurality of the amplifiers to send the amplified analog triangle wave signals to the plurality of the MEMS scanning mirrors respectively.

13. The operation method of claim 8, further comprising: using the FPGA causes a display device to render an imaging screen based on the at least one image data through a USB (universal serial bus) control chip.
